

# Ernest SONG ♦ Finance Domain Leader

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| <p>Rue Montagne de l'Oratoire 28/76<br/>B-1000 Brussels<br/>contact@ernestsong.com<br/>ernestsong.com<br/>+32 476 60 05 90</p> | <p>Finance leader with 15+ years leading accounting and transformation mandates for multi-entity, multi-country organisations across BE, FR and NL. I specialise in General Accounting (GL, AP, AR) and financial-close leadership, and in guiding ERP replacements from AS-IS diagnosis to SAP S/4HANA go-live. What sets me apart is perspective: I've sat on both the operator's and the executive-recruiter's side of the table, so I read the numbers and the organisation behind them. I bring calm under pressure, rigorous Power BI / Cognos reporting, and a genuine commitment to turning finance into a lever for growth.</p> |
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| Education                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Competencies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Languages                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| <p><b>ESCP Business School</b><br/>(#1 FT 2026)<br/>2010 – 2011   Paris, FR<br/>Specialized Master's degree<br/>Auditing and Consulting</p> <p><b>Université Paris Nanterre</b><br/>2005 – 2010   Paris, FR<br/>Master's degree<br/>Management Science and Financial Control</p> | <p><b>Business</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• MS Office (advanced Excel, Power Query)</li></ul> <p><b>ERP</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• SAP HANA</li></ul> <p><b>Business Intelligence</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• MS Power BI</li><li>• QlikSense</li><li>• Business Object</li><li>• Cognos</li><li>• Hyperion</li></ul> <p><b>RPA</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• UiPath</li><li>• MS PowerAutomate</li></ul> | <p><b>Native:</b> French, Khmer, Teochew<br/><b>Proficient:</b> English<br/><b>Basics:</b> Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin</p> <p><b>Interests</b></p> <p>Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis</p> <p><b>Interpersonal</b></p> <p>Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer</p> |

## Professional Experience

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| <p><b>Engie SEM</b></p> <p><b>Strategic Business Analyst &amp; Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Led month-end/year-end GL close for up to 6 BE/FR/NL entities (ERP replacing legacy AS/400), strengthening financial-close control across the multi-entity group.</li><li>• Drove AS-IS to TO-BE process design for finance sub-processes, coordinating cross-functional workshops and stakeholder sign-off.</li><li>• Automated the financial close with PowerQuery ETL, ingesting 1,500+ bookings per close with zero manual intervention.</li><li>• Trained end-users on Infor M3 and validated UAT for finance sub-processes before go-live, documenting steering-committee sign-off.</li></ul> | <p>January 2026 – Present   Brussels, BE</p>       |
| <p><b>Holcim</b></p> <p><b>Senior Operational Excellence &amp; Data Lead (Freelancer)</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Managed the SAP HANA ERP data migration, restructuring data and preserving system integrity.</li><li>• Rolled out Qlik Sense finance reporting, building 8 executive dashboards that shortened reporting cycles by 50% and enabled faster, evidence-based managerial decisions.</li><li>• Built rebate models (matrix &amp; automated SAP) aligned to commercial strategy, driving €150M annual rebate volume with 99.8% accuracy and resolving commercial disputes 30% faster.</li><li>• Guaranteed data reliability and partnered with auditors on rebate matters.</li></ul>                                    | <p>January 2024 – December 2025   Nivelles, BE</p> |
| <p><b>Engie Tractebel</b></p> <p><b>Cash Flow &amp; Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Designed cash-flow reporting and per-project financing-need assessment.</li><li>• Assessed local financing needs, performed countercredit analysis, and conducted impairment testing.</li><li>• Engineered finance data models from SAP HANA, delivering 8 Power BI executive dashboards that turned raw transactions into decision-ready insights for finance leadership.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <p>March 2023 – December 2023   Brussels, BE</p>   |

## **Shurgard**

February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE

### **Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer)**

- Advised on self-storage M&A transactions worth €10M to €80M, structuring and negotiating acquisitions, restructurings, and divestitures.
- Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures.
- Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts.
- Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.

## **Magnetrap**

November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE

### **Head of Controlling**

- Acted as interim CFO and led fundraising, organizing €3M in debt/equity fund raises.
- Produced cash-flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals.
- Monitored company performance and drove corrective actions.
- Prepared operating results reports and maintained financial models for long-term use.

## **Tobania**

February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE

### **Director Business Process Automation**

- Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities.
- Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers.
- Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.

## **Soap collect**

January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH

### **Founder**

- Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.

## **Degroof Petercam**

January 2018 – December 2018 | Brussels, BE

### **Performance Management Project Leader**

- Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM)
- Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality.
- Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards.
- Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.

## **Vinci Airports**

February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT

### **Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent**

- Led the group's subsidiaries, contributing to a €12B valuation.
- Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries.
- Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation.
- Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes.
- Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.

## **Rexel**

September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR

### **Freelance Finance Consolidation & Reporting Consultant**

- Managed consolidated reporting across a €3B-turnover scope spanning LATAM, APAC, and Canada, aligning GL/AP/AR flows for strong financial-close control.
- Integrated SAP BPC and Cognos reporting, strengthening GL/AP consolidated reporting.
- Ran annual budgeting and monthly forecasting (actual vs. budget).

**KPMG Audit**

January 2011 – August 2014 | Paris, FR

**Financial Auditor Supervisor**

- Audited financial statements under multiple accounting standards (BE-GAAP, SOX), strengthening GL and financial-close controls.
- Audited financial modelling for long-term PPP contracts.
- Certified FP7 grant agreements; led audit teams and supervised auditors.

**ICM - Brain & Spine Institute**

November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR

**Deputy CFO Trainee**

- Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.
- Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.
- Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the "Comité de la Charte".